

according to a report commissioned by The Council of Capital City Lord Mayors. Sydney, which has Australia’s most vibrant nightlife, generates more than \$3.64 billion in night-time revenue each year, with around 4,600 businesses employing more than 32,000 people, according to the city’s administration.

In that context, the Indian economy, too, stands to gain if a structured night-time economy is established in the country’s cities. “If a night-time policy is implemented along with concessions for the shopping sector, then we can expect around 20-25 per cent increase in job opportunities across maintenance, security, and managerial roles. We can expect around 20-25 per cent more revenue to be generated if malls are allowed to open throughout,” says Jayen Naik, Chief Operations Officer of Nexus Malls.

While most metropolitan cities in India have some regulations allowing the operation of workplaces at night in industries such as IT & ITes, a more holistic approach to policymaking is required to establish a thriving night-time economy in the cities. The benefit of such a change will not only be reflected in more places for the city’s residents to visit during the night, but also allow Indian cities to compete as tourist hotspots with global peers that are considered the doyens of city nightlife. According to Batra of Cafe Delhi Heights, since Delhi does not have an established night-time ecosystem, it has become a transit city for many international tourists in India. “Goa’s nightlife is the big attraction, and that is why international tourists coming to India go to Goa. Sometimes foreigners, or my relatives come to India, and then we feel embarrassed thinking about where to take them,” he says.

Around the world, the most sought after tourist destinations have one thing in common: a thriving night-time economy. Barcelona, Madrid, San Francisco, London, Berlin, Sydney and New York are just some examples of a vibrant night-time economy, and that is why these cities get the sobriquet of ‘the city that never sleeps, or the city of owls’. “In



“If we get the government’s support in terms of policy, I am sure what business we are doing throughout the day, we will do that business in 4-5 hours at night”

SHARAD MADAN
CO-FOUNDER, IMPERFECTO
AND KHUBANI



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JAYEN NAIK
CHIEF OPERATIONS OFFICER,
NEXUS MALLS

15-20
PER CENT
THE EXPECTED JUMP IN JOBS IF RESTAURANTS AND HOTELS ARE ALLOWED TO OPERATE THROUGH THE NIGHT
SOURCE INDUSTRY

Spain’s Barcelona and Madrid, 6 am in the morning is like 6 pm in the evening in Delhi. Barcelona and Madrid are quintessential examples of thriving night-time economies,” says Khubani’s Madan.

But Indian metropolitan cities are slowly and steadily moving towards the concept of creating a flourishing night-time economy. Many states are trying to give fresh impetus to economic growth. In this year’s budget of the Delhi government, Finance Minister Manish Sisodia announced the preparation of a policy that would allow food trucks to operate at designated places in the city from 8 pm to 2 am. This step was aimed at strengthening the night economy of Delhi, and create more jobs. Even Delhi’s former Lieutenant Governor Anil Baijal last year said that the Delhi Master Plan 2041—which will be notified later this year—is a continuing and prospective document that aims to make Delhi an internationally acclaimed night-